# HEARTS OF PALM SALAD

*An incredibly flavorful salad with surprising ingredients –that will exceed all expectations. Every time I make this salad, I get asked for the recipe.*

**Origin**

*Hearts of palm salads trace their culinary origins to **Central America, South America, and Southeast Asia**, where indigenous communities have harvested the edible inner cores of native palm trees for thousands of years*

*Long before the ingredient appeared in modern supermarkets, civilizations like the **Mayans** relied on wild palm trees (such as the açaí, peach palm, and palmetto) as a vital food source. Indigenous groups used all parts of the tree and would boil or eat the soft, white inner bud raw, often tossing it with other native vegetation. In Florida, Native Americans and early settlers harvested local sabal palms to make a variation traditionally known as "swamp cabbage" salad*

## At a Glance

- **Prep Time:** Estimated time, 20-30 minutes
- **Cook Time:** Estimated time, 30 minutes
- **Servings:** Number of servings, 6-8

## Preparation – *Mis en place –Everything in its place*

*Tasks to complete before the main cooking begins to ensure a smooth process.*

- **Bake:** asparagus
- **Cook:** quinoa and farro
- **Chop/Dice:** spinach, avocado, hearts of palm, tomatoes
- **Assemble Tools:** griddle, cooking sheet, pot, large bowl for serving

## Ingredients

**Primary Plant Protein/Base:**

- Farro & quinoa

**Fresh Produce & Aromatics:**

- 2 large packages of spinach- roughly chopped
- 2 avocados
- 2 cups of sliced tomatoes
- 2 packages of asparagus – cut in thirds after baked

**Dressing**

- 2 lemons - juiced
- 2 tbs of olive oil

**Pantry Staples & Seasonings:**

- 1 cup quinoa - 1 ¾ cup
- 1 cup farro – to 21/2 cups of water
- 1 jar/can hearts of palm sliced

**Garnishes/Toppings:** ○ n/a

## 🔪 Directions

*Clear, sequential steps to guide the cooking process. Cook in "layers"*

1. **Prepare**

    1. **quinoa and faro**–toast the grains and add boil water with a sprinkle of salt. Add 2 cups of water. Let it come to a boil, cover and let simmer. For 15 minutes.

2. **Pre- cook asparagus**

    1. Preheat oven to 400. Place asparagus on a try and spray lightly with Olive oil spray with a little salt and pepper Remove from the oven as they get lightly crispy. Once cooled, cut into thirds.

3. Cut vegetables
    a. Cut avocado into cubes and sprinkle with lemon.
    b. Roughly chop spinach
    c. Slice cherry tomatoes in half
    d. Slice hearts of palm in ½ inch cubes
    .

3. **Make the dressing** – add 2 tbs olive oil, 1 lemon and 1 tsp salt. Taste and add more as needed.

4. **Combine the rest of ingredients**

    1. Add the spinach to a bowl. Then add asparagus, hearts of palm, cherry tomatoes. Add in the cooled grains. Top with the avocadoes.

    2. Add the dressing. Add salt.

    3. Taste: add more salt, lemon and olive oil as needed.

## 💡 Quick Tips

*Bonus advice for variations, efficiency, and sustainability.*

- **Flavor Boost:** add more edamame and or orzo if you want a less leafy salad.
- **Substitution:** can add different types of lettuce or cabbage.
- **Meal Prep Hack:** Separate the parts you don't want to serve and combine later along with adding the dressing when ready to serve

## Nutritional Information

*Estimated values Per ½ cup*

| | |
|---|---|
| Spinach | 7 Calories, 0.9 g protein: .4 g carbs: .2 g fiber: .7 g fiber for 1 cup<br>Spinach is a nutrient-dense, low-calorie superfood. It is an excellent source of vitamins K, A, and folate |
| Tomatoes | Per one cup. 27 calories, 6 g carbs, and 1.8 g fiber<br>They provide powerful antioxidants and essential nutrients that lower disease risk and improve daily cellular function. |
| Hearts of palm | Per half cup - 20 cal, 4g carbs, 4 g of fiber, 2 g protein<br>Very low in fat and calories while high in water and fiber, which helps you feel full. Rich in potassium. |
| Farro | Per one cup, 200 cal, 37g carb, 7g fiber, 0g sugar, 7g protein, 1.5 g fat<br>The primary benefit of farro is its ability to support heart health and digestion through its exceptionally high fiber and antioxidant content. |
| Quinoa | Per one cup, 222 cal, 8.1 g protein, 39.4 g carbs, 5.2 g fiber, 3.6 g fat. 1.6 g sugar<br>Improves metabolic health, aids digestion, and lowers chronic disease risk due to its rich mix of fiber, minerals, and unique plant antioxidant |
| Avocado | 160 calories (per 100g), 2 g protein, 7 g fiber, 8.5 g carbs, 15g healthy fats (most are monosaturated fat)<br>Includes 20 different vitamins and minerals, notably: potassium, vitamins K, B9, C, E, and B6, magnesium & copper. |
| Asparagus | 20 cal, ½ cup, 2 gm protein and 2g fiber, and very low fat<br>Has antioxidants and other important micronutrients. It is packed with vitamins (A, C, E, K, B vitamins), minerals (folate, potassium, iron, copper), fiber, and antioxidants, offering benefits for heart health, digestion, immunity, and cell protection |

## *What are hearts of Palm? Is it good for you?*

It is a white, crunchy vegetable harvested from the inner core of certain palm trees. It is mostly sourced from coconut, açai, and peach palm trees grown in tropical regions like Central and South America.

Hearts of palm are exceptionally good for you. They provide a high concentration of essential nutrients with very few calories, making them a highly functional addition to most diets.

## *What is farro? Is it good for you?*

Farro is a nutrient-rich ancient whole grain with a nutty flavor and chewy texture. It is a type of wheat that has been a staple in Mediterranean and Italian cooking for thousands of years.

Farro is exceptionally good for you**.** It is a nutrient-dense whole grain that provides significantly more health benefits than refined grains like white rice or standard pasta

## *What is quinoa? Is it good for you?*

It is a pseudocereal, meaning it is a seed cooked and eaten like a grain, yet it belongs to the broadleaf goosefoot family alongside spinach and beets rather than the true grass family. It is naturally gluten-free, packed with complete protein – containing all 9 essential amino acids

Quinoa is exceptionally good for you. It is considered a functional superfood because it contains a rare combination of complete protein, high fiber, and essential minerals that support overall health.